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Ever wondered what the difference between cursor, claude code, and copilot is if you can use opus 4.5 through any of them?





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One thing people often dont realise is that the LLM is only 1 part of the problem that needs to be solved for a good agentic coding experience.





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The other, which is as (if not more) important is the scaffolding around it.





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- what context gets sent to the model (and how much)
- system prompts
- agentic loop
- tool orchestration
- error handling & iteration

there's a ton of decisions being made around the LLM that decides what gets sent to it and how to handle the output.





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Which is why cc/cursor/copilot/windsurf (now antigravity) all feel different despite using the same set of models.





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Honestly I thought cursor would win here - they were the first agentic coding tool to go mainstream, so they should've had the most signal on engineer workflows to build the best scaffolding. But the tide seems to be shifting toward pure CLI tools like claude code and codex.





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As for cc vs codex - feels like the curse of two equally good options. If claude 5.2 means codex pulls ahead, fine - I'm not chasing 10% gains. I'll switch when reddit/x is overwhelmingly in favour of one. Right now there's enough back and forth to conclude it's not worth it.

